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System and method of selective auxiliary data capture

Abstract

A method of auxiliary data capture control includes: storing, at a data capture device, (i) detection criteria corresponding to events having respective event identifiers; and (ii) a registration indicator associated with at least one of the event identifiers; controlling a primary data capture sensor to obtain primary captured data; in response to detecting, based on the primary captured data, that the detection criteria are satisfied for a detected one of the event identifiers, determining whether the registration indicator is associated with the detected event identifier; and when the registration indicator is associated with the detected event identifier, controlling an auxiliary data capture sensor to obtain auxiliary captured data.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The current application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/100,438, filed on Jan. 13, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/723,220, filed on Dec. 20, 2019, both of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Data capture devices, such as barcode scanners, can capture various types of data, and provide such data to host computers for further processing. Certain types of data, such as images, can be computationally costly for the host computers to process.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying figures, where like reference numerals refer to identical or functionally similar elements throughout the separate views, together with the detailed description below, are incorporated in and form part of the specification, and serve to further illustrate embodiments of concepts that include the claimed invention, and explain various principles and advantages of those embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a system for selective auxiliary data capture.

- (3) FIG. 2 is an isometric view of a data capture device of the system of FIG. 1.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a flowchart of a method of selective auxiliary data capture.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart of a method for performing blocks **315** and **320** of the method of FIG. 3.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a flowchart of another method for performing block **315** of the method of FIG. 3.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of a further method for performing block **315** of the method of FIG. 3.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating event registration indicators in the system of FIG. 1.
- (9) Skilled artisans will appreciate that elements in the figures are illustrated for simplicity and clarity and have not necessarily been drawn to scale. For example, the dimensions of some of the elements in the figures may be exaggerated relative to other elements to help to improve understanding of embodiments of the present invention.
- (10) The apparatus and method components have been represented where appropriate by conventional symbols in the drawings, showing only those specific details that are pertinent to understanding the embodiments of the present invention so as not to obscure the disclosure with details that will be readily apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art having the benefit of the description herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (11) Examples disclosed herein are directed to a method of auxiliary data capture control, the method comprising: storing, at a data capture device, (i) detection criteria corresponding to events having respective event identifiers; and (ii) a registration indicator associated with at least one of the event identifiers; controlling a primary data capture sensor to obtain primary captured data; in response to detecting, based on the primary captured data, that the detection criteria are satisfied for a detected one of the event identifiers, determining whether the registration indicator is associated with the detected event identifier; and when the registration indicator is associated with the detected event identifier, controlling an auxiliary data capture sensor to obtain auxiliary captured data.
- (12) Additional examples disclosed herein are directed to a data capture device, comprising: a memory storing (i) detection criteria corresponding to events having respective event identifiers; and (ii) a registration indicator associated with at least one of the event identifiers; a primary data capture sensor; an auxiliary data capture sensor; and a processor connected with the memory, the primary data capture sensor and the auxiliary data capture sensor, the processor configured to: control the primary data capture sensor to obtain primary captured data; in response to detecting, based on the primary captured data, that the detection criteria are satisfied for a detected one of the event identifiers, determine whether the registration indicator is associated with the detected event identifier; and when the registration indicator is associated with the detected event identifier, control the auxiliary data capture sensor to obtain auxiliary captured data.
- (13) FIG. 1 illustrates a system **100** for capturing primary and auxiliary data associated with items. Example items include products in a retail facility. Primary data associated with such items can include product identifiers such as Universal Product Codes (UPCs), which may be encoded in an indicium such as a barcode affixed to an item or stored in a radio frequency identification (RFID) tag affixed to the item. Another example of primary data includes a weight of the item. A further example of primary data includes an indication of the presence of an Electronic Article Surveillance (EAS) tag affixed to the item.
- (14) The system **100** includes a data capture device **104** configured to capture the above-mentioned primary data. The data capture device **104** can provide the primary data to a host computing device **108**, for example via a network **112**, which can include any suitable combination of local and wide-area networks. The host computing device **108** can include, for example, a point-of-sale (PoS) computing device configured to further process the primary data. Such processing can include retrieving additional information (e.g. a price) from a database stored at, or otherwise connected with, the host computing device **108**. Such information can be presented on a display of the host computing device, printed on a receipt, and the like.

(15) The host computing device **108** can also be configured to perform other functions that employ data beyond the primary data mentioned above, referred to as auxiliary data. For example, the host computing device **108** can be configured to implement at least one item recognition mechanism, for example to detect the type of an item when the item does not carry a product identifier (e.g. encoded in a barcode or RFID tag). Another example function that uses auxiliary data includes storing an image of the surroundings of the data capture device **104** at the time that the primary data was captured, e.g. for security purposes.

(16) The auxiliary data includes image data in the examples discussed herein, although in other examples the auxiliary data can include other types of data in addition to, or instead of, image data. Implementing functions that use auxiliary data can be costly in terms of computational and storage resources. Therefore, the system **100** enables selective capture of auxiliary data that may mitigate the above-mentioned computational and storage costs.

(17) The data capture device **104** includes a controller such as a central processing unit (CPU), also referred to as a processor **116** interconnected with a non-transitory computer readable storage medium, such as a memory **120**. The memory **120** includes any suitable combination of volatile memory (e.g. Random Access Memory (RAM)) and non-volatile memory (e.g. read only memory (ROM), Electrically Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory (EEPROM), flash). The processor **116** and the memory **120** each comprise one or more integrated circuits (ICs).

(18) The processor **116**, as will be discussed in greater detail below, controls various data capture sensors of the data capture device **104** to capture the above-mentioned primary and auxiliary data. The processor **116** also determines, based on captured primary data, when to capture auxiliary data. In particular, the processor **116** executes machine-readable instructions stored in the memory **120** and referred to herein as a data capture control application **124** (or simply as the application **124**) to perform the above functionality. Execution of the application **124** configures the processor **116** to capture and provide primary data to the host computing device **108**, and also to determine, based at least in part on a repository **128** stored in the memory **120**, whether to trigger the capture of auxiliary data.

(19) The repository **128** contains registration indicators corresponding to at least one event for which detection criteria are defined in the application **124**. When a given event is detected and is associated with a registration indicator in the repository **128**, the processor **116** initiates the capture of auxiliary data.

(20) In other examples, the contents of the repository **128** can be integrated into the application **124**. In addition, the functionality discussed herein need not be implemented via the execution of a single application. In other examples, the memory **120** can store at least one application enabling the processor **116** to control the data capture sensors mentioned earlier. Such an application may expose, via an application programming interface (API) or the like, event identifiers to an additional application that determines when to capture auxiliary data.

(21) The above-mentioned data capture sensors include at least one primary data capture sensor and at least one auxiliary data capture sensor. In the illustrated example, the data capture device **104** includes three primary data capture sensors, including a primary image sensor **132**, a weigh-scale **136** (also referred to simply as a scale **136**), and a short-range communications assembly **140**. Other examples of primary data capture sensors include a laser-based barcode scanner (e.g. instead of, or in addition to, the primary image sensor **132**), an infrared sensor and the like.

(22) The auxiliary data capture sensor, in the illustrated example, is an auxiliary image sensor **144**. The auxiliary image sensor **144**, in this example, is a color image sensor, while the primary image sensor **132** can be a black and white image sensor. Further, the auxiliary image sensor **144** may have a greater resolution than the primary image sensor **132**.

(23) The data capture device **104** also includes a communications interface **148**, enabling the data capture device **104** to exchange data with other computing devices, such as the host computing device **108**. The communications interface **148** includes any suitable hardware (e.g. Network

Interface Controllers (NICs), Universal Serial Bus (USB) controllers, and the like) allowing the data capture device **104** to communicate over the network **112**.

(24) The above-mentioned components of the data capture device **104** can be implemented in various form factors. Turning to FIG. 2, an example data capture device **104** is shown in the form of a bioptic scanner that can be mounted in a retail checkout countertop or other support surface.

(25) In the example illustrated in FIG. 2, the data capture device **104** includes a housing **200** containing the components mentioned above in connection with FIG. 1. The housing defines a platform **204** on which items may be placed and over which a scan volume **206** is defined, e.g. by scan windows **208** and **212**. The scale **136** is coupled to the platform **204**, and the primary image sensor **132** has a field of view extending from at least one of the windows **208** and **212**. The data capture device **104** can include an optical assembly enabling the primary image sensor **132** to capture images via either window **208** and **212**, or the data capture device **104** can include two primary image sensors, with respective fields of view traversing the scan windows **208** and **212**.

(26) The auxiliary image sensor **144** is also disposed within the housing **200** such that a field of view of the auxiliary image sensor **144** extends from one of the scan windows **208** and **212**. In other examples, however, the auxiliary image sensor **144** can be contained in another housing separate from the housing **200**, and communicatively coupled with the processor **116** (within the housing **200**). In further examples, the auxiliary image sensor **144** can be deployed along with an auxiliary controller distinct from the processor **116**, and an auxiliary communications interface (e.g. a USB interface) distinct from the interface **148**. In such implementations, the auxiliary controller can communicate with both the processor **116** and the host computing device **108**.

(27) As will be apparent to those skilled in the art, primary data capture may be initiated by passing an item through the scan volume **206**, placing an item on the platform **204**, activating an input of the device **104**, or the like. Turning now to FIG. 3, the actions performed by the data capture device **104** during primary data capture operations in order to control auxiliary data capture will be described in greater detail.

(28) FIG. 3 illustrates a method **300** of selective auxiliary data capture. The method **300** will be described below in conjunction with its performance in the system **100**, and in particular by the data capture device **104**. It is contemplated, however, that the method **300** can also be performed in various other suitable systems.

(29) At block **305**, the data capture device **104** is configured to obtain event registrations. The data capture device **104** stores (e.g. within the application **124**) event detection criteria corresponding to a plurality of events. When the detection criteria for a given event are satisfied, the processor **116** generates an event identifier, which may be processed in various ways.

(30) Various events and corresponding detection criteria are contemplated. For example, when an indicium such as a barcode is detected in an image captured by the primary image sensor **132**, and data is successfully decoded from the barcode, the data capture device **104** can be configured to transmit the decoded data to the host computing device **108**. The host computing device **108**, in turn, can be configured to return a “scan disable” command to the data capture device **104**. The scan disable command instructs the data capture device **104** to pause primary data capture, e.g. for a predefined period of time (e.g. one second, although shorter and longer time periods are also contemplated) or until a resume command is received from the host computing device **108**.

Processing of decoded data by the host computing device **108** may consume more time than the next capture operation at the data capture device **104**. The scan disable command can therefore be employed to enable the host computing device **108** to complete processing of the decoded data before the data capture device **104** sends additional decoded data. Various other example events and detection criteria associated therewith will be described below.

(31) An event registration is associated with a specific event, and is an indication that when that event occurs (i.e. when the detection criteria defining that event are satisfied), the data capture device **104** is to capture auxiliary data for provision to the host computing device **108**. In other

words, event registrations indicate which events the host computing device **108** is subscribed to. The event registrations are stored in the repository **128** in the present example. For example, the repository **128** can contain registration indicators in the form of event identifiers of events to which the host computing device **108** is subscribed. In other examples, the repository **128** can contain each event identifier, and a flag associated therewith indicating whether or not the host computing device **108** is subscribed to that event.

(32) The event registrations can be obtained at block **305** at the time of deployment of the application **124** to the data capture device **104** (that is, the event registrations can be hard-coded at the data capture device **104**). In other examples, the event registrations can be received from the host computing device **108** separately from deployment of the application **124**, e.g. in a request via the network **112**. In further examples, in which the auxiliary image sensor **144** is associated with a distinct auxiliary controller and auxiliary communications interface, the event registrations can be stored in a memory connected to the auxiliary controller rather than in the repository **128**. That is, the host computing device **108** can pass event registrations to the auxiliary controller via the auxiliary communications interface.

(33) At block **310**, the data capture device **104** is configured to control at least one of the data capture sensors mentioned above to capture data. For example, the processor **116** can enable at least one of the primary image sensor **132**, the scale **136** and the short-range interface **140**. Enabling the primary image sensor **132** may include capturing a stream of image frames at a suitable frequency and evaluating each frame according to the event detection criteria mentioned above.

(34) At block **315**, the data capture device **104** is configured to determine whether any of the event detection criteria mentioned above are satisfied by the data captured via the primary data capture sensors at block **310**. When the determination at block **315** is affirmative the data capture device **104** proceeds to block **320** to process the captured data. When the determination at block **315** is negative, the data capture device **104** can discard the data captured at block **310**, and repeat the performance of block **310** to capture further data. As indicated by the dashed line from block **320** to block **315**, a single capture of data at block **310** may also be evaluated more than once for event criteria. In other examples, block **320** can precede block **315**.

(35) As noted earlier, various forms of event criteria can be evaluated at block **315**. Turning to FIG. 4, an example method **400** of implementing blocks **315** and **320** is illustrated. In particular, the method **400** implements two sequential instances of blocks **315** and **320**. At block **405**, the processor **116** determines whether an indicium such as a barcode, QR Code, Digimarc or the like has been detected in a frame of image data captured via the primary image sensor **132**. When the determination at block **405** is negative, the processor **116** returns to block **310** (i.e. a negative determination at block **405** is equivalent to a negative determination at block **315**).

(36) When the determination at block **405** is affirmative, the processor **116** proceeds to block **410**. In other examples, the processor **116** can perform block **410** regardless of the determination at block **405**. In further examples, following an affirmative determination at block **405** the processor **116** can generate a “Decode” event before proceeding to block **410**. The Decode event indicates that an indicium has been detected and decoded at block **405**, and can also be employed to trigger the capture of auxiliary data.

(37) At block **410** the processor **116** determines whether the image captured at block **305** via the primary image sensor **132** is sufficiently similar to a preceding image (e.g. the previous captured frame from the primary image sensor **132**). Various mechanisms for measuring similarity between images may be implemented at block **410**, including those based on feature matching (with an affirmative determination resulting at block **410** when threshold number or proportion of matching features are detected between the current and previous frames).

(38) In other examples, the processor can perform the determination at block **410** by determining whether the code detected in the captured frame at block **405** is a new code. A new code is one that

does not match a preceding code (i.e. detected in the previous frame of image data from the primary image sensor **132**), or that matches a preceding code when a timeout period has expired (e.g. 2 seconds, although other time periods can also be employed). Whether a detected barcode is new or not indicates whether a different item has been placed in the scan volume **206**. Detection of a new code at block **410** results in a negative determination. When the code is not new, the determination at block **410** is affirmative, indicating that the item in the scan volume **206** is the same item as in the preceding image frame, rather than a different item.

(39) Following an affirmative determination at block **410**, the processor **116** may be configured not to send data decoded from the barcode to the host computing device **108** (because such data was already sent in connection with the previous image frame). However, the processor **116** can be configured to generate an “Imager Stable” event and proceed to block **320**. An “imager stable” event indicates that the item present in the scan volume **206** is the same as a previously detected item. The event indicates that the item is currently stable within the scan volume **206** and therefore that imaging via the auxiliary image sensor **144** may be feasible. As will now be apparent, an affirmative determination at block **405** followed by a negative determination at block **410** is an example implementation of block **315** in which the event criteria for the “imager stable” event is satisfied. The performance of block **320** following such an event can include updated a most recently detected barcode indicator in the memory **120**.

(40) When the determination at block **410** is negative, indicating that the barcode detected at block **405** is different from the preceding code detected from primary image data, the processor **116** proceeds to block **415**. At block **415**, which represents an example implementation of block **320** as shown in FIG. 3, the processor **116** can send the data decoded from the new barcode to the host computing device **108**.

(41) Following the transmission at block **415**, the processor **116** determines, at block **420**, whether a “scan disable” command has been received from the host computing device **108**. As will now be apparent, the performance of block **415** represents an additional implementation of block **315** (i.e. another evaluation of event detection criteria). When the determination at block **420** is negative, the data capture device **104** can simply return to block **310**, or can repeat block **420** until a timeout period is reached.

(42) When a scan disable command is received, leading to an affirmative determination at block **420**, the processor **116** proceeds to block **320**, where processing of the scan disable command can include interrupting image capture and/or decoding processes.

(43) Returning to FIG. 3, following the performance of block **320**, for example according to the implementations discussed above in connection with FIG. 4, the processor **116** is configured, at block **325**, to determine whether the event or events detected at block **315** are registered events. That is, the processor **116** is configured to determine whether the event identifier of the event detected at block **315** appears in the repository **128** as an event to which the host computing device **108** is subscribed. In examples in which the auxiliary image sensor **144** is associated with a distinct auxiliary controller that stores event registrations as mentioned earlier, the determination at block **325** can be performed by the auxiliary controller instead of the processor **116**. That is, the processor **116** can be configured to simply pass all event detections from block **315** to the auxiliary controller, and the auxiliary controller can assess whether each event is a registered event at block **325**.

(44) When the determination at block **325** is negative, the processor **116** returns to block **310** to capture further data via the primary data capture sensors. When the determination at block **325** is affirmative, however, the processor **116** proceeds to block **330**. At block **330**, the processor **116** controls the auxiliary image sensor **144** to capture an image frame, and sends the captured image frame to the host computing device **108**. In other examples, the auxiliary image sensor **144** operates in a video mode, and therefore captures a stream of image frames throughout the performance of the method **300**. In such examples, at block **330** the processor **116** is configured to retrieve the most recent frame captured by the auxiliary image sensor **144** and transmit the retrieved image frame to

the host computing device **108**. The processor **116** then returns to block **305**. In other examples, in which the auxiliary image sensor **144** is associated with a separate auxiliary controller, the auxiliary controller performs block **330**, controlling the auxiliary image sensor **144** to capture an image for transmission to the host computing device **108** via the auxiliary communications interface.

(45) Turning now to FIG. **5**, another example implementation of block **315** is illustrated as a method **500**, which can be performed simultaneously with the implementation shown in FIG. **4**, or instead of the implementation shown in FIG. **4**. In the implementation shown in FIG. **5**, the data captured at block **305** includes data generated by the scale **136** (e.g. a mass of an item on the scale, in any suitable unit).

(46) At block **505** the processor **116** is configured to determine whether the data received from the scale **136** indicates a non-zero weight. That is, the processor **116** determines whether an item is present on the platform **204**. When the determination at block **505** is negative because the data from the scale **136** indicates zero weight (or a weight below a configurable threshold), the processor **116** returns to block **310**.

(47) When the determination at block **505** is affirmative, at block **510** the processor **116** determines whether a variance in the signal from the scale **136** falls below a threshold. The threshold applied at block **510** is selected such that variance below the threshold indicates that the item on the platform **204** is substantially stationary. Variance above the threshold indicates that the item is in motion, and that it may therefore not currently be feasible to obtain an accurate weight or to capture an auxiliary image of the item. For example, the threshold can include a time period (e.g. 0.5 seconds, although other time periods may also be employed) and a maximum permitted change in the data received from the scale **136** over the time period (e.g. 1 gram, although various other permitted changes can also be employed).

(48) When the determination at block **510** is negative, indicating that the item is in motion, the processor **116** can repeat block **510**, or simply return to block **310**. When the determination at block **510** is affirmative, the processor **116** proceeds to block **320**, and then to block **325**, as discussed above.

(49) FIG. **6** illustrates a further example implementation of block **315** illustrated as a method **550**, which can be performed simultaneously with the implementation shown in FIG. **4**, or instead of the implementation shown in FIG. **4**. In the implementation shown in FIG. **6**, the data captured at block **305** includes data generated by the short-range communications interface **140**. Such data can include a proximity indicator, which can be determined from various parameters including a signal strength measurement. An example of a signal strength measurement used to generate the proximity indicator is a Received Signal Strength Indicator (RSSI) representing the detected signal strength of a nearby RFID tag, EAS tag, or the like. Such data can also include an identifier or other data encoded in the above-mentioned tags, which can be received at the interface **140**.

(50) At block **555** the processor **116** is configured to determine, from a proximity indicator based on an RSSI value and/or other suitable parameters generated from a tag transmission or reflection, whether the proximity indicator exceeds a threshold selected to indicate the presence of a nearby tag. When the determination at block **555** is negative, the processor **116** returns to block **310**. In other examples, the determination at block **555** includes a determination of whether the proximity indicator has exceeded the threshold continuously for at least a threshold time period (e.g. 1.5 seconds, although shorter and longer time periods are also contemplated). Such a determination indicates that the wireless tag has remained near the data capture device **104** for the time period, rather than having been detected as the wireless tag is carried past the data capture device **104**.

(51) When the determination at block **555** is affirmative, at block **560** the processor **116** determines whether a tag identifier has been received. In other words, the determinations at block **555** and **560** assess whether an RFID or EAS tag is not only close enough to the short-range interface **140**, but also whether an identifier or other payload data from the tag has been retrieved by the data capture device **104**.

(52) When the determination at block **560** is negative, the processor **116** can repeat block **560**, or simply return to block **310**. When the determination at block **560** is affirmative, the processor **116** proceeds to block **320**, and then to block **325**, as discussed earlier.

(53) The repository **128** (or, in other implementations as mentioned earlier, an auxiliary controller associated with the auxiliary image sensor **144**) can contain a plurality of event registration indicators. That is, an application executed by the host computing device **108** can subscribe to more than one event. Further, multiple events may occur simultaneously, or at least within a certain time period. Under such conditions, the data capture device **104** can simply capture and send auxiliary data to the host computing device **108** for each registered event. However, this may result in redundant auxiliary data being sent to the host computing device **108**. Therefore, in some examples the repository **128** can also include priority indicators for each registered event.

(54) Turning to FIG. 7, example contents for the repository **128** is shown, including two registration indicators **700-1** and **700-2** identifying the “scan disable” event mentioned earlier, as well as a “stable weight” event detected via the method **500**. In addition, the repository **128** includes a priority indicator **704-1**, **704-2** corresponding to each registration indicator **700**. When two or more events are detected at block **315** within a configurable time period (e.g. 0.5 seconds), the processor **116** may be configured to assess only one of the events at block **325** according to the priority indicators **704**. Thus, in the example shown in FIG. 6, only the scan disable event would be processed at block **330**.

(55) The repository **128** can also include additional data, for example to specify auxiliary data capture parameters. For example, each event registration can specify different capture parameters (e.g. exposure time, flash and the like) for controlling the auxiliary image sensor **144**. In other examples, the data capture device **104** can include multiple auxiliary data capture sensors, and different event registrations can configure the processor **116** to activate different ones of the auxiliary data capture sensors.

(56) In further variations, the host computing device **108** itself can perform blocks **325** and **330**. In particular, rather than the processor **116** or the auxiliary controller associated with the auxiliary image sensor **144** storing event registrations, the host computing device **108** can maintain the event registrations. The processor **116** can simply report all detected events to the host computing device **108**, and the auxiliary image sensor **144** (e.g. via the auxiliary controller and communications interface) can provide a stream of images, e.g. for storage in a buffer at the host computing device **108**. The host computing device **108** is then configured to determine whether an event reported by the processor **116** corresponds to an event registration, and to retrieve a relevant frame from the above-mentioned buffer when the even does correspond to an event registration.

(57) In the foregoing specification, specific embodiments have been described. However, one of ordinary skill in the art appreciates that various modifications and changes can be made without departing from the scope of the invention as set forth in the claims below. Accordingly, the specification and figures are to be regarded in an illustrative rather than a restrictive sense, and all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of present teachings.

(58) The benefits, advantages, solutions to problems, and any element(s) that may cause any benefit, advantage, or solution to occur or become more pronounced are not to be construed as a critical, required, or essential features or elements of any or all the claims. The invention is defined solely by the appended claims including any amendments made during the pendency of this application and all equivalents of those claims as issued.

(59) Moreover in this document, relational terms such as first and second, top and bottom, and the like may be used solely to distinguish one entity or action from another entity or action without necessarily requiring or implying any actual such relationship or order between such entities or actions. The terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “has”, “having,” “includes”, “including,” “contains”, “containing” or any other variation thereof, are intended to cover a non-exclusive inclusion, such that a process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises, has, includes, contains a

list of elements does not include only those elements but may include other elements not expressly listed or inherent to such process, method, article, or apparatus. An element preceded by “comprises . . . a”, “has . . . a”, “includes . . . a”, “contains . . . a” does not, without more constraints, preclude the existence of additional identical elements in the process, method, article, or apparatus that comprises, has, includes, contains the element. The terms “a” and “an” are defined as one or more unless explicitly stated otherwise herein. The terms “substantially”, “essentially”, “approximately”, “about” or any other version thereof, are defined as being close to as understood by one of ordinary skill in the art, and in one non-limiting embodiment the term is defined to be within 10%, in another embodiment within 5%, in another embodiment within 1% and in another embodiment within 0.5%. The term “coupled” as used herein is defined as connected, although not necessarily directly and not necessarily mechanically. A device or structure that is “configured” in a certain way is configured in at least that way, but may also be configured in ways that are not listed.

(60) It will be appreciated that some embodiments may be comprised of one or more specialized processors (or “processing devices”) such as microprocessors, digital signal processors, customized processors and field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs) and unique stored program instructions (including both software and firmware) that control the one or more processors to implement, in conjunction with certain non-processor circuits, some, most, or all of the functions of the method and/or apparatus described herein. Alternatively, some or all functions could be implemented by a state machine that has no stored program instructions, or in one or more application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), in which each function or some combinations of certain of the functions are implemented as custom logic. Of course, a combination of the two approaches could be used.

(61) Moreover, an embodiment can be implemented as a computer-readable storage medium having computer readable code stored thereon for programming a computer (e.g., comprising a processor) to perform a method as described and claimed herein. Examples of such computer-readable storage mediums include, but are not limited to, a hard disk, a CD-ROM, an optical storage device, a magnetic storage device, a ROM (Read Only Memory), a PROM (Programmable Read Only Memory), an EPROM (Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory), an EEPROM (Electrically Erasable Programmable Read Only Memory) and a Flash memory. Further, it is expected that one of ordinary skill, notwithstanding possibly significant effort and many design choices motivated by, for example, available time, current technology, and economic considerations, when guided by the concepts and principles disclosed herein will be readily capable of generating such software instructions and programs and ICs with minimal experimentation.

(62) The Abstract of the Disclosure is provided to allow the reader to quickly ascertain the nature of the technical disclosure. It is submitted with the understanding that it will not be used to interpret or limit the scope or meaning of the claims. In addition, in the foregoing Detailed Description, it can be seen that various features are grouped together in various embodiments for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. This method of disclosure is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that the claimed embodiments require more features than are expressly recited in each claim. Rather, as the following claims reflect, inventive subject matter lies in less than all features of a single disclosed embodiment. Thus the following claims are hereby incorporated into the Detailed Description, with each claim standing on its own as a separately claimed subject matter.

Claims

1. A method of auxiliary data capture control, the method comprising: storing (i) detection criteria each corresponding to one of a plurality of events; and (ii) a registration indicator associated with at least one of the events; controlling a primary data capture sensor to obtain primary captured data; in

response to detecting, based on the primary captured data, that the detection criteria are satisfied for a detected one of the events, determining whether the registration indicator is associated with the detected event; and when the registration indicator is associated with the detected event, controlling an auxiliary data capture sensor to obtain auxiliary captured data.

2. The method of claim 1, further comprising: transmitting the auxiliary captured data to a host computing device.

3. The method of claim 1, further comprising: storing first and second registration indicators and, for each registration indicator, a priority indicator.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein controlling the auxiliary data capture sensor to obtain auxiliary captured data includes controlling an auxiliary image sensor to capture an image frame.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein controlling a primary data capture sensor includes controlling a barcode scanner.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein a subset of the detection criteria includes whether the primary captured data contains an indicium, the method further comprising: sending the primary captured data to a host computing device.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein a further subset of the detection criteria includes whether a scan disable command has been received, the method further comprising: in response to sending the primary captured data to a host computing device, repeating the determination of whether the registration indicator is associated with the detected event, in response to receipt of a scan disable command from the host computing device.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein a subset of the detection criteria includes whether the primary captured data matches preceding primary captured data.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein a subset of the detection criteria includes whether a variance in the primary captured data over a configurable time period is below a threshold.

10. The method of claim 1, wherein a subset of the detection criteria includes whether a proximity indicator associated with a wireless tag exceeds a threshold.

11. The method of claim 1, wherein a subset of the detection criteria includes whether a wireless tag identifier has been received from a wireless tag.
